

Sweating - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1330 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Excessive sweating (hyperhidrosis) assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published excessive sweating guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant/recently postpartum, when did sweating begin, is it generalized/night-time or localized, and are there fever, weight loss, chest/breathing symptoms, fainting, glucose/heat/poisoning exposure, medicine/substance change, or child safeguarding concerns?
2. [YES_NO] Does it happen at night?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] Any other symptoms, like fever, weight loss, or chest pain?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Carbon Monoxide Exposure

Did the sweating begin during or after possible exposure to a faulty heater, generator, fire, charcoal, gas appliance, or enclosed-space fumes?

Symptoms associated with possible carbon monoxide exposure belong in the Carbon Monoxide Exposure pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Along with the sweating, is there chest pain, difficulty breathing, confusion, or fainting?

Sudden profuse sweating combined with chest pain, breathing difficulty, confusion, or fainting is a recognized red flag for a serious underlying cause (such as a heart attack or severe infection) and needs immediate emergency care.

1. Disposition level 70

Has the sweating lasted at least 6 months, does it happen at least weekly or interfere with daily activities, does it happen at night, is there a family history, or is it not helped by things tried so far?

NHS.UK guidance recommends clinical review for these persistent, functionally-limiting, or unexplained sweating patterns.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this mild, occasional sweating with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes mild sweating as manageable at home with clothing and antiperspirant measures.

Advice

Qatar emergency sweating-associated response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for sweating with chest pain, abnormal breathing, fainting, confusion, seizure, stroke signs, severe weakness, suspected hypoglycaemia, heat illness, poisoning/carbon monoxide, sepsis, or pregnancy/postpartum danger signs. Move from heat or a suspected exposure only if safe and do not give food, drink, or medicine if consciousness/swallowing is impaired. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening chest pain or breathing; confusion, fainting, seizure, or weakness; heat, poisoning, infection, or glucose emergency.

Urgent sweating review

- Arrange a primary-care appointment to investigate the cause and discuss treatment options.
- Call Back If: new symptoms develop; sweating worsens.

Governed care for non-urgent sweating

- Use loose breathable clothing, change damp clothing/socks, maintain usual fluids if not restricted, and avoid known triggers. Antiperspirant or medicine advice requires age, pregnancy/breastfeeding, skin integrity, endocrine/cardiac conditions, interactions, and approved Qatar pharmacy guidance. New night sweats, weight loss, fever, medicine/substance change, or a child with unexplained sweating needs in-person assessment.
- Call Back If: persistent or worsening sweating; night sweats, fever, weight loss, palpitations, or functional impact.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for sweating with chest pain, abnormal breathing, fainting, confusion, seizure, stroke signs, severe weakness, suspected hypoglycaemia, heat illness, poisoning/carbon monoxide, sepsis, or pregnancy/postpartum danger signs. Move from heat or a suspected exposure only if safe and do not give food, drink, or medicine if consciousness/swallowing is impaired. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Excessive sweating (hyperhidrosis)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/excessive-sweating-hyperhidrosis/> (page last reviewed 07 November 2023)

Provenance

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